



PRIMARY TEXT SOURCE ASSESSMENT

EAP II: Academic Writing

Writing Project #3 — Step 3

Presenter: Zilin Yuan

Continuance Intention and Addiction

*Analyzing the Role of Escapism
in Balanced Gaming Engagement*

Li, Hui, & Reiners (2025)

IEEE SOLI 2025 · Singapore



Title and Author

"Continuance Intention and Addiction: Analyzing the Role of Escapism in Balanced Gaming Engagement"

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They explore disciplines related to business management, information systems, game design, and consumer behavior.

Publication & Date

2025 IEEE SOLI

International Conference on Service Operations and Logistics, and Informatics

IEEE is a major technical professional organization. This conference publishes peer-reviewed academic papers.

Audience: academics, researchers, and technology industry professionals.

Date: September 28–30, 2025

Context at Time of Publication

- Gaming industry generating billions in revenue globally
- Game addiction emerged as a pressing social and economic concern
- Increasing scrutiny on ethical responsibilities of game developers
- Lawsuits over game addiction (e.g., Fortnite class-action)
- WHO's classification of gaming disorder (ICD-11)

Discipline & Topic

Discipline

Information Systems, Business Management, and Cyberpsychology

Topic

The paper explores the tension between "continuance intention" (sustained player engagement/loyalty) and game addiction.

Key Sub-Topics

Escapism

Seeking distraction from real-life problems through gaming

Enjoyment

Intrinsic pleasure derived from gameplay experience

Hedonic Systems

Platforms where enjoyment matters more than utility for sustained engagement

Self-Escape Theory

Individuals engage in impulsive behaviors to escape negative self-awareness (shame, guilt, failure)



Genre & Organization

Genre

Academic Conference Paper / Empirical Research Study

Uses a highly structured format (Abstract → Introduction → Literature Review → Methodology → Analysis → Discussion → Conclusion) to logically build its case. Employs statistical modeling and visual diagrams to validate hypotheses objectively.

Organization & Rhetorical Strategies

Organization

Establishes a real-world business and ethical problem, reviews existing theories (TAM, SET) to build hypotheses, details a survey of 123 Pokémon Go players, presents findings, and concludes with practical implications.

Rhetorical Strategies

Logos: quantitative survey data, Cronbach's alpha reliability tests, and p-values

Ethos: citing WHO and established academic theories (TAM, SET)



Main Ideas (1 of 2)

1 Enjoyment Drives Both Positive and Negative Outcomes

Intrinsic enjoyment is a strong predictor of both continuance intention (healthy, sustained engagement) and game addiction. It is a double-edged sword — the very quality that makes games successful can also lead to problematic use.

2 Escapism Is Solely Linked to Addiction

Escapism (an extrinsic motivation — playing to avoid real-life stress) significantly predicts game addiction but does not significantly predict continuance intention. This makes escapism the key factor that separates healthy engagement from addictive behavior.



Main Ideas (2 of 2)

3 Ethical Game Design Is Possible

Developers can balance business goals (monetization, player retention) with ethical responsibility by designing experiences that focus on player enjoyment while actively minimizing or mitigating features that exploit escapist motives.



Core Takeaway

The study shows that promoting enjoyment while reducing escapism-driven engagement is the path to sustainable, responsible game design — good for business and good for players.



Limitations

- Small sample size ($n = 123$) limits the ability to test more complex models
- Geographic limitation — paper-based responses gathered exclusively in Perth, Australia
- Single game studied (Pokémon GO) may not generalize across other game genres
- Data collected in 2017 — player behaviors and the gaming landscape may have evolved significantly since then

Implications

- Design for enjoyment — engaging mechanics and intuitive interfaces promote healthy player loyalty
- Mitigate escapism — implement time limits and in-game reminders for at-risk players
- Use behavioral data and surveys to identify escapist players and offer tailored interventions
- Future research should use larger and more diverse samples, and examine moderating factors such as age, gender, and game genre

Reflection

What I Learned

I learned the clear distinction between enjoyment and escapism in gaming. While both keep players playing, escapism is the key factor that pushes behavior from healthy engagement into addiction.

Discipline Takeaway

In the discipline of Information Systems, business goals (like monetization and retention) must often be carefully balanced against human psychology and ethical design.

Process Change

Assessing this source showed me the importance of looking for empirical data to support psychological claims, and it helped me narrow my focus to the specific motivations behind user engagement.

” My Own Considerations (1 of 2)

Limitations of My Own Understanding

- As someone still developing research literacy, the statistical methods (SEM, bootstrapping) were initially difficult to interpret
- The study focuses on one game — I wonder how findings would differ for genres like MMOs or mobile puzzle games
- Cultural factors are not deeply explored — gaming culture varies significantly across regions
- The paper suggests developers should design less addictive games by minimizing escapism — but in reality, the gaming industry is driven by profit and engagement metrics, making it unlikely that companies would voluntarily reduce the very features that keep players hooked

” My Own Considerations (2 of 2)

Implications for My Research

- This paper reinforced the value of distinguishing between types of user motivation, not just measuring engagement overall
- It pushed me to think about ethical dimensions in technology design — something I want to explore further
- I plan to look for more studies that compare healthy vs. unhealthy user behaviors across different platforms

Works Cited

Li, Mengyuan, Wendy Wan Yee Hui, and Torsten Reiners. "Continuance Intention and Addiction: Analyzing the Role of Escapism in Balanced Gaming Engagement." 2025 IEEE International Conference on Service Operations and Logistics, and Informatics (SOLI), IEEE, 2025, pp. 58-62.

Keywords

Surveys

Ethics

Addiction

Games

Mathematical Models

Data Models

IP Networks

Cultural Differences

Informatics

Logistics